

TABLE 2.9 POPULATION BY DISTRICTS AND INTERCENSAL RATES OF GROWTH 1946 - 1971

District	Population				Average annual intercensal rate of growth		
	1946	1953	1963	1971	1946-53	1953-63	1963-71
Sri Lanka(All Districts)	6,657,339	8,097,895	10,582,064	12,689,897	2.8	2.6	2.2
Colombo	1,420,332	1,708,726	2,207,420	2,672,265	2.7	2.5	2.3
Kalutara	456,572	523,550	631,457	729,514	2.0	1.8	1.7
Kandy	711,449	840,382	1,043,632	1,187,925	2.4	2.1	1.6
Matale	155,720	201,049	255,630	314,841	3.7	2.3	2.6
Nuwara Eliya	268,121	325,254	397,756	450,278	2.8	2.0	1.5
Galle	459,785	524,369	641,474	735,173	1.9	2.0	1.6
Matara	351,947	413,431	514,969	586,443	2.3	2.2	1.6
Hambantota	149,686	191,508	274,297	340,254	3.5	3.5	2.7
Jaffna	424,788	491,849	612,596	701,603	2.1	2.2	1.6
Mannar	31,538	43,689	60,124	77,780	4.7	3.1	3.1
Vavuniya	23,246	35,112	68,621	95,243	6.0	6.8	4.1
Batticaloa	203,186	270,493	196,189	256,721	4.2	4.1	3.3
Amparai (1)	-	-	211,732	272,605	-	-	3.1
Trincomalee	75,926	83,917	138,553	188,245	1.4	5.0	3.8
Kurunegala	485,042	626,336	852,661	1,025,633	3.7	3.0	2.3
Puttalam	182,847	228,892	302,546	378,430	3.2	2.8	2.8
Anuradhapura	139,534	229,282	279,788	388,770	7.4	5.4	4.1
Polonnaruwa (1)	-	-	113,971	163,653	-	-	4.5
Badulla	372,238	466,896	521,845	615,405	3.3	3.3	2.1
Moneragala (1)	-	-	132,260	193,020	-	-	4.7
Ratnapura	343,620	421,555	546,037	661,344	3.0	2.5	2.3
Kegalle	401,762	471,605	578,506	654,752	2.3	2.0	1.5

(1) Until the Census of 1963 Amparai, Polonnaruwa and Moneragala districts formed parts of Batticaloa, Anuradhapura and Badulla districts respectively.